

A HEALTHY PLATFORM

AS THE PHARMACY OF THE WORLD, THE G20 PRESIDENCY OFFERS INDIA'S HEALTHCARE AND PHARMA INDUSTRY A GOLDEN OPPORTUNITY TO FOSTER GLOBAL COLLABORATIONS AND TAKE IT TO NEW HEIGHTS

BY **NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA**

ILLUSTRATION BY **RAJ VERMA**

THE COVID-19 PANDEMIC in 2020 was an unexpected boon for India's drugs and pharmaceuticals industry: foreign direct investment (FDI) shot up by 188 per cent to \$1.5 billion in 2020-21 from \$517 million in 2019-20.

The FDI came into India's manufacturing prowess in vaccines. The next year, FDI slipped by 5 per cent but surged by 46 per cent in 2022-23.

All this is good news for India's presidency of the G20 bloc. The G20 presidency, say industry experts, has given centre stage to India, reaffirming its position as a leading player in healthcare and pharmaceuticals.

And it is not just vaccines: over the past five years, top multinationals have been injecting FDI into India's drugs and pharmaceuticals sector. The Indian pharma sector is the